Kitsune — News Desk Briefing
Prepared: 3/18/2026, 4:13:35 PM

Kitsune's Digest

Greetings. The ink is fresh upon the parchment, and the lanterns flicker against the coming dawn. I have gathered the whispers of the world into a single, disciplined scroll for your inspection. Here is the state of the scroll as it stands.

MAIN HEADLINES

• Israel kills Iran's spy chief as regional tensions escalate.
• Israeli strikes on Iran's South Pars gas field drive oil prices toward $110 a barrel.
• Iran missiles cause "extensive damage" to a refinery in Qatar.
• Federal Reserve holds interest rates steady as Chair Powell vows to remain through a DOJ probe.
• Civil rights icon Cesar Chavez faces posthumous allegations of sexual abuse.
• US intelligence officials are accused of omitting Iran data that contradicts President Trump.
• Nigerian soldiers repel a drone attack, killing 80 Islamic extremists.
• Orlando begins the demolition of the Pulse nightclub to make way for a memorial.
• An arrest has been made in the 15-year-old cold case murder of an Iowa realtor.
• President Trump honors six US troops killed in a Middle East plane crash.
• A 5-year-old is reportedly scarred by hot chocolate at a California resort, prompting a lawsuit.
• Philadelphia Eagles acquire quarterback Andy Dalton in a trade with the Panthers.

THEMES

• **Global Energy Volatility:** Military strikes on Iranian infrastructure are causing immediate and sharp increases in global oil prices.
• **Institutional Friction:** Significant tension is emerging between the White House, the Federal Reserve, and intelligence agencies regarding policy and transparency.
• **Historical Reckoning:** Long-standing legacies and cold cases are being revisited through new allegations, arrests, and the removal of physical monuments.

CATEGORIES

USA
• The Federal Reserve maintains current interest rates amid geopolitical uncertainty.
• A statue of Cesar Chavez at Fresno State is covered following abuse allegations.

• Orlando begins demolition of the Pulse nightclub site for a permanent memorial.
• A New York City student is released after 10 months in ICE detention.
• Senator Rand Paul faces scrutiny over past "duel" comments following criticism of Markwayne Mullin.
• Northern Lights may be visible in 18 US states tonight.

WORLD
• Israel destroys river bridges in southern Lebanon and strikes Iranian gas fields.
• Tehran missiles hit a refinery in Qatar; Iran-US conflict continues to intensify.
• Nigerian forces repel a drone strike on a military base; 80 extremists reported killed.
• Pakistan announces a pause in Afghanistan airstrikes for the Eid holiday.
• Delcy Rodriguez is named Venezuela's new Defence Minister.
• Cuba's president warns of "impregnable resistance" following US threats.

TECH
• Representative Elissa Slotkin introduces a bill to limit the Pentagon's use of AI.
• An Amazon delivery business owner is found guilty of a $10M fraud scheme.
• Hyundai issues recalls and stops some SUV sales following the death of a child.

ENTERTAINMENT
• The cause of death for legendary singer Neil Sedaka has been revealed.
• A new docuseries claims Bob Barker struggled significantly after his wife's death.
• Maika Monroe's drama *In Cold Light* becomes available for home viewing.
• *Cross* Season 2 ending is explained by streaming analysts.

SPORTS
• The Eagles bolster their roster by trading for veteran QB Andy Dalton.
• Former QB Chase Daniel reveals how a Chiefs signing saved his long-distance romance.
• Concordia track star Matthew Wing has died in a car crash at age 22.
• Betting odds and predictions are released for the March Madness matchup between SMU and Miami (OH).

OTHER
• Shaquille O'Neal offers to cover funeral costs for a 12-year-old girl killed after a fight.
• A couple is arrested in Atlanta for stealing over 300 lottery tickets.
• A house being transported on a North Carolina highway caused a major traffic jam.

WATCHLIST / UNKNOWN

• **Missing Person:** The location and status of Alabama student James Gracey, missing in Spain, remains unresolved.
• **Economic Impact:** It is unknown if oil prices will stabilize or continue to climb if the Strait

of Hormuz faces further disruption.
• **Legal Proceedings:** The federal murder trial for Luigi Mangione awaits a decision on a requested postponement.
• **Intelligence Integrity:** Investigation into claims that top spies omitted Iran intel is ongoing.
• **Diplomatic Fallout:** The impact of the Israeli strike on the Qatar refinery on US-Qatar relations is yet to be determined.

SOURCES
System source stats:
• Feeds in profile: 10
• Headlines scanned: 190
• Digest items passed to model: 60
• Unique domains in digest items: 8

Sources used (deduped by domain):
• The Independent World (independent.co.uk) — 19
  • Example: Amazon delivery business owner stole $10M to buy luxury cars and fund lavish lifestyle
  • Example: Orlando starts demolition of Pulse nightclub where 49 were killed to make way for permanent memorial
• New York Post (nypost.com) — 17
  • Example: Chase Daniel and wife reveal how ‘last-minute’ Chiefs signing saved long-distance romance
  • Example: BetMGM bonus code NYPDM1500: Get a 20% first deposit match up to $1,500 for Miami (OH) vs. SMU
• NYT (nytimes.com) — 9
  • Example: Mullin Signals He Would End Noem Policy That Slowed Disaster Aid
  • Example: Iran Is Already a Quagmire
• Al Jazeera (aljazeera.com) — 7
  • Example: Iranians burn Trump, Netanyahu effigies at warship victim rally
  • Example: US Fed keeps interest rates steady amid economic, geopolitical uncertainty
• BBC News (bbc.com) — 3
  • Example: King praises 'living bridge' with Nigeria at glitzy banquet
  • Example: Oil nears $110 a barrel after gas field strike
• New York Post (decider.com) — 3
  • Example: ‘Reminders of Him’ Isn’t Streaming Yet, But Another (and Better!) 2026 Maika Monroe Drama Is Available to Wat…
  • Example: ‘Cross’ Season 2 Ending Explained: Does Luz Kill Lance Durand?
• NPR Topics: World (npr.org) — 1
  • Example: Iran war hinders the flow of U.N. aid through the Gulf to communities in need
• World & Nation (latimes.com) — 1

• Example: Israel kills Iran's spy chief; Gabbard says government is 'intact but largely degraded'

Feed titles encountered (raw RSS, debug):
• New York Post
• The Independent World
• NYT > Top Stories
• BBC News
• Al Jazeera – Breaking News, World News and Video from Al Jazeera
• World & Nation
• NPR Topics: World